

Screenplay Workbook

A writing room in your pocket

TITLE

WRITTEN BY

FORMAT

DRAFT

STARTED

CONTACT

Tap a tab at the top of any page to jump to that section.
Start with Home → Guide if this is your first time.

Home

Your map of the workbook. Tap any box or number to jump there.

Idea

Logline, premise, theme and synopsis

[Log](#)[Prem](#)[Syn](#)

Story

Structure: acts, beats and sequences

[Acts](#)[Beats](#)[Seq](#)[Plots](#)

Cast

Cast list, character profiles and relationship map

[List](#)[1](#)[2](#)[3](#)[4](#)[5](#)[6](#)[7](#)[8](#)[Map](#)

Scenes

60 scene cards and a locations list

[1](#)[7](#)[13](#)[19](#)[25](#)[31](#)[37](#)[43](#)[49](#)[55](#)[Loc](#)

Outline

Step outline: the whole story scene by scene

Script

40 guided pages for drafting by hand (jump by page)

[1](#)[6](#)[11](#)[16](#)[21](#)[26](#)[31](#)[36](#)

Notes

Rewrite checklist, feedback log and blank pages

[Rew](#)[Fdbk](#)[Blank](#)

Guide

How to use this, screenplay format, Fountain and lengths

[Start](#)[Fmt](#)[Ftn](#)[Len](#)

Logline

One sentence that sells the story: who wants what, what stands in the way, and what happens if they fail.

When [INCITING INCIDENT], a [FLAWED PROTAGONIST] must [GOAL] or else [STAKES], despite [ANTAGONIST / OBSTACLE].

PROTAGONIST *Who, plus the flaw that makes it hard for them*

INCITING INCIDENT *What knocks their world off balance?*

GOAL *Specific and visible: what can the camera see them chase?*

ANTAGONIST / OBSTACLE *Who or what actively opposes them?*

STAKES *What happens if they fail?*

THE HOOK *What's fresh or ironic about this?*

LOGLINE, DRAFT 1

LOGLINE, DRAFT 2

LOGLINE, DRAFT 3

Premise & Theme

What the story is, and what it's really about.

GENRE

tone

target length

audience / rating

COMPARABLE TITLES "X meets Y"; recent and successful

THEME What question does the story ask about how to live?

CONTROLLING IDEA The story's answer: "___ happens when ___"

CENTRAL DRAMATIC QUESTION Will [hero] [achieve goal]?

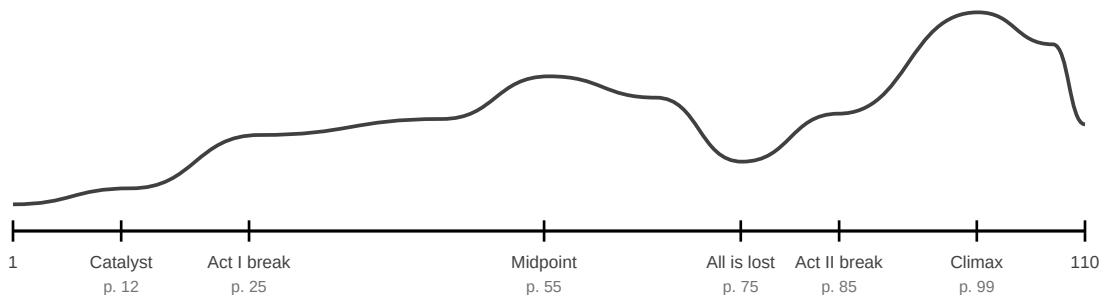
WHY THIS STORY, WHY ME, WHY NOW?

title ideas

Three-Act Structure

The shape of a 110-page feature. Mark where your turning points land.

TENSION



ACT I • Setup

pp. 1–25

Who is the hero, what do they want, and what disrupts their world?

ACT IIA • Rising action

pp. 25–55

What new world or plan do they commit to? What's fun about it?

ACT IIB • Things fall apart

pp. 55–85

How do the stakes rise? What do they lose?

ACT III • Resolution

pp. 85–110

How do they win or lose, and who are they now?

Beat Sheet

Blake Snyder's *Save the Cat!* beats, scaled to 110 pages.

1. OPENING IMAGE

p. 1

A snapshot of the hero and their world before the story changes them.

2. THEME STATED

p. 5

Someone (rarely the hero) voices what the story is really about.

3. SET-UP

pp. 1–10

Hero, world, and what's missing in their life. Plant what will pay off later.

4. CATALYST

p. 12

The inciting incident that knocks the hero's world off balance.

5. DEBATE

pp. 12–25

The hero hesitates. Should I go? What will it cost?

Beat Sheet (cont.)

6. BREAK INTO TWO

p. 25

The hero chooses to enter the new world and pursue the goal.

7. B STORY

p. 30

A new relationship that carries the theme: love interest, mentor, rival.

8. FUN AND GAMES

pp. 30–55

The promise of the premise: the set pieces the trailer is made of.

9. MIDPOINT

p. 55

A false victory or false defeat. Stakes rise; a clock may start ticking.

10. BAD GUYS CLOSE IN

pp. 55–75

Outside pressure and inside doubt tighten around the hero.

Beat Sheet (cont.)

11. ALL IS LOST

p. 75

The lowest point. Something or someone dies, literally or symbolically.

12. DARK NIGHT OF THE SOUL

pp. 75–85

The hero wallows, then finally grasps the lesson of the theme.

13. BREAK INTO THREE

p. 85

A and B stories meet; armed with the lesson, the hero acts.

14. FINALE

pp. 85–110

The hero proves they've changed and confronts the central conflict.

15. FINAL IMAGE

p. 110

A mirror of the Opening Image that shows how much has changed.

Eight Sequences

Break the script into eight ~15-minute movements, each with its own mini-goal and turn.

SEQ 1 · STATUS QUO & INCITING INCIDENT

pp. 1–14

Establish the hero's world; end on the event that disrupts it.

SEQ 2 · PREDICAMENT & LOCK-IN

pp. 15–28

The hero reacts, then commits to the goal. End of Act I.

SEQ 3 · FIRST OBSTACLE

pp. 29–41

The first, most obvious attempt to solve the problem.

SEQ 4 · ESCALATION TO MIDPOINT

pp. 42–55

Bigger attempts, bigger failures, leading to the midpoint turn.

SEQ 5 · COMPLICATION

pp. 56–69

A new plan after the midpoint; subplots deepen and cost rises.

SEQ 6 · LOWEST POINT

pp. 70–82

Everything the hero tried collapses. End of Act II.

SEQ 7 · NEW TENSION & FINAL PUSH

pp. 83–96

A twist or revelation sets up the last attempt.

SEQ 8 · CLIMAX & RESOLUTION

pp. 97–110

The final confrontation, then a glimpse of the new normal.

Plot & Subplot Tracker

Where does each storyline advance? One row per plot; note its beat in each act.

PLOT	ACT I	ACT IIA	ACT IIB	ACT III
A				
B				
C				
D				
E				
F				

Character 1

NAME

AGE

☐ Protagonist
 ☐ Antagonist
 ☐ Ally
 ☐ Mentor
 ☐ Love interest
 ☐ Other

LOOK & FIRST IMPRESSION *How we meet them on the page*

WANT *Their conscious, external goal*

NEED *What they must learn or accept*

WOUND *The past event that shaped them*

FLAW & THE LIE THEY BELIEVE

ARC *Who they are on page 1 → who they are at the end*

VOICE *Vocabulary, rhythm, what they never say*

SECRET

KEY RELATIONSHIPS

Character 2

NAME**AGE**

☐ Protagonist ☐ Antagonist ☐ Ally ☐ Mentor ☐ Love interest ☐ Other

LOOK & FIRST IMPRESSION *How we meet them on the page***WANT** *Their conscious, external goal***NEED** *What they must learn or accept***WOUND** *The past event that shaped them***FLAW & THE LIE THEY BELIEVE****ARC** *Who they are on page 1 → who they are at the end***VOICE** *Vocabulary, rhythm, what they never say***SECRET****KEY RELATIONSHIPS**

Character 3

NAME**AGE**

☐ Protagonist ☐ Antagonist ☐ Ally ☐ Mentor ☐ Love interest ☐ Other

LOOK & FIRST IMPRESSION *How we meet them on the page***WANT** *Their conscious, external goal***NEED** *What they must learn or accept***WOUND** *The past event that shaped them***FLAW & THE LIE THEY BELIEVE****ARC** *Who they are on page 1 → who they are at the end***VOICE** *Vocabulary, rhythm, what they never say***SECRET****KEY RELATIONSHIPS**

Character 4

NAME**AGE**

☐ Protagonist ☐ Antagonist ☐ Ally ☐ Mentor ☐ Love interest ☐ Other

LOOK & FIRST IMPRESSION *How we meet them on the page***WANT** *Their conscious, external goal***NEED** *What they must learn or accept***WOUND** *The past event that shaped them***FLAW & THE LIE THEY BELIEVE****ARC** *Who they are on page 1 → who they are at the end***VOICE** *Vocabulary, rhythm, what they never say***SECRET****KEY RELATIONSHIPS**

Character 5

NAME**AGE**

☐ Protagonist ☐ Antagonist ☐ Ally ☐ Mentor ☐ Love interest ☐ Other

LOOK & FIRST IMPRESSION *How we meet them on the page***WANT** *Their conscious, external goal***NEED** *What they must learn or accept***WOUND** *The past event that shaped them***FLAW & THE LIE THEY BELIEVE****ARC** *Who they are on page 1 → who they are at the end***VOICE** *Vocabulary, rhythm, what they never say***SECRET****KEY RELATIONSHIPS**

Character 6

NAME

AGE

☐ Protagonist
 ☐ Antagonist
 ☐ Ally
 ☐ Mentor
 ☐ Love interest
 ☐ Other

LOOK & FIRST IMPRESSION *How we meet them on the page*

WANT *Their conscious, external goal*

NEED *What they must learn or accept*

WOUND *The past event that shaped them*

FLAW & THE LIE THEY BELIEVE

ARC *Who they are on page 1 → who they are at the end*

VOICE *Vocabulary, rhythm, what they never say*

SECRET

KEY RELATIONSHIPS

Character 7

NAME

AGE

☐ Protagonist
 ☐ Antagonist
 ☐ Ally
 ☐ Mentor
 ☐ Love interest
 ☐ Other

LOOK & FIRST IMPRESSION *How we meet them on the page*

WANT *Their conscious, external goal*

NEED *What they must learn or accept*

WOUND *The past event that shaped them*

FLAW & THE LIE THEY BELIEVE

ARC *Who they are on page 1 → who they are at the end*

VOICE *Vocabulary, rhythm, what they never say*

SECRET

KEY RELATIONSHIPS

Character 8

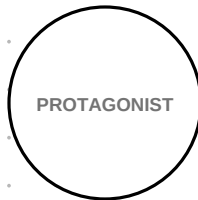
NAME**AGE**

☐ Protagonist ☐ Antagonist ☐ Ally ☐ Mentor ☐ Love interest ☐ Other

LOOK & FIRST IMPRESSION *How we meet them on the page***WANT** *Their conscious, external goal***NEED** *What they must learn or accept***WOUND** *The past event that shaped them***FLAW & THE LIE THEY BELIEVE****ARC** *Who they are on page 1 → who they are at the end***VOICE** *Vocabulary, rhythm, what they never say***SECRET****KEY RELATIONSHIPS**

Relationship Map

Put your protagonist in the middle. Draw lines to others; label each with the conflict.



Scene Cards

One card per scene. Every scene needs a goal, a conflict and a turn.

#1

☐ INT ☐ EXT ☐ DAY ☐ NIGHT

pg ____

LOCATION

WHO

GOAL

CONFLICT

TURN

+ / -

#2

☐ INT ☐ EXT ☐ DAY ☐ NIGHT

pg ____

LOCATION

WHO

GOAL

CONFLICT

TURN

+ / -

#3

☐ INT ☐ EXT ☐ DAY ☐ NIGHT

pg ____

LOCATION

WHO

GOAL

CONFLICT

TURN

+ / -

#4

☐ INT ☐ EXT ☐ DAY ☐ NIGHT

pg ____

LOCATION

WHO

GOAL

CONFLICT

TURN

+ / -

#5

☐ INT ☐ EXT ☐ DAY ☐ NIGHT

pg ____

LOCATION

WHO

GOAL

CONFLICT

TURN

+ / -

#6

☐ INT ☐ EXT ☐ DAY ☐ NIGHT

pg ____

LOCATION

WHO

GOAL

CONFLICT

TURN

+ / -

SCENE CARDS · 7-12

#7

☐

INT

☐

EXT

☐

DAY

☐

NIGHT

pg ____

LOCATION

WHO

GOAL

CONFLICT

TURN

+ / -

#8

☐

INT

☐

EXT

☐

DAY

☐

NIGHT

pg ____

LOCATION

WHO

GOAL

CONFLICT

TURN

+ / -

#9

☐

INT

☐

EXT

☐

DAY

☐

NIGHT

pg ____

LOCATION

WHO

GOAL

CONFLICT

TURN

+ / -

#10

☐

INT

☐

EXT

☐

DAY

☐

NIGHT

pg ____

LOCATION

WHO

GOAL

CONFLICT

TURN

+ / -

#11

☐

INT

☐

EXT

☐

DAY

☐

NIGHT

pg ____

LOCATION

WHO

GOAL

CONFLICT

TURN

+ / -

#12

☐

INT

☐

EXT

☐

DAY

☐

NIGHT

pg ____

LOCATION

WHO

GOAL

CONFLICT

TURN

+ / -

SCENE CARDS · 13–18

#13

☐ INT ☐ EXT ☐ DAY ☐ NIGHT

pg ____

LOCATION _____

WHO _____

GOAL _____

CONFLICT _____

TURN _____

+ / -

#14

☐ INT ☐ EXT ☐ DAY ☐ NIGHT

pg ____

LOCATION _____

WHO _____

GOAL _____

CONFLICT _____

TURN _____

+ / -

#15

☐ INT ☐ EXT ☐ DAY ☐ NIGHT

pg ____

LOCATION _____

WHO _____

GOAL _____

CONFLICT _____

TURN _____

+ / -

#16

☐ INT ☐ EXT ☐ DAY ☐ NIGHT

pg ____

LOCATION _____

WHO _____

GOAL _____

CONFLICT _____

TURN _____

+ / -

#17

☐ INT ☐ EXT ☐ DAY ☐ NIGHT

pg ____

LOCATION _____

WHO _____

GOAL _____

CONFLICT _____

TURN _____

+ / -

#18

☐ INT ☐ EXT ☐ DAY ☐ NIGHT

pg ____

LOCATION _____

WHO _____

GOAL _____

CONFLICT _____

TURN _____

+ / -

SCENE CARDS · 19–24

#19

☐ INT☐ EXT☐ DAY☐ NIGHT

pg ____

LOCATION

WHO

GOAL

CONFLICT

TURN

+ / -

#20

☐ INT☐ EXT☐ DAY☐ NIGHT

pg ____

LOCATION

WHO

GOAL

CONFLICT

TURN

+ / -

#21

☐ INT☐ EXT☐ DAY☐ NIGHT

pg ____

LOCATION

WHO

GOAL

CONFLICT

TURN

+ / -

#22

☐ INT☐ EXT☐ DAY☐ NIGHT

pg ____

LOCATION

WHO

GOAL

CONFLICT

TURN

+ / -

#23

☐ INT☐ EXT☐ DAY☐ NIGHT

pg ____

LOCATION

WHO

GOAL

CONFLICT

TURN

+ / -

#24

☐ INT☐ EXT☐ DAY☐ NIGHT

pg ____

LOCATION

WHO

GOAL

CONFLICT

TURN

+ / -

SCENE CARDS · 25–30

#25

☐

INT

☐

EXT

☐

DAY

☐

NIGHT

pg ____

LOCATION

WHO

GOAL

CONFLICT

TURN

+ / -

#26

☐

INT

☐

EXT

☐

DAY

☐

NIGHT

pg ____

LOCATION

WHO

GOAL

CONFLICT

TURN

+ / -

#27

☐

INT

☐

EXT

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DAY

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NIGHT

pg ____

LOCATION

WHO

GOAL

CONFLICT

TURN

+ / -

#28

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INT

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EXT

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DAY

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NIGHT

pg ____

LOCATION

WHO

GOAL

CONFLICT

TURN

+ / -

#29

☐

INT

☐

EXT

☐

DAY

☐

NIGHT

pg ____

LOCATION

WHO

GOAL

CONFLICT

TURN

+ / -

#30

☐

INT

☐

EXT

☐

DAY

☐

NIGHT

pg ____

LOCATION

WHO

GOAL

CONFLICT

TURN

+ / -

SCENE CARDS · 31–36

#31

☐

INT

☐

EXT

☐

DAY

☐

NIGHT

pg ____

LOCATION

WHO

GOAL

CONFLICT

TURN

+ / -

#32

☐

INT

☐

EXT

☐

DAY

☐

NIGHT

pg ____

LOCATION

WHO

GOAL

CONFLICT

TURN

+ / -

#33

☐

INT

☐

EXT

☐

DAY

☐

NIGHT

pg ____

LOCATION

WHO

GOAL

CONFLICT

TURN

+ / -

#34

☐

INT

☐

EXT

☐

DAY

☐

NIGHT

pg ____

LOCATION

WHO

GOAL

CONFLICT

TURN

+ / -

#35

☐

INT

☐

EXT

☐

DAY

☐

NIGHT

pg ____

LOCATION

WHO

GOAL

CONFLICT

TURN

+ / -

#36

☐

INT

☐

EXT

☐

DAY

☐

NIGHT

pg ____

LOCATION

WHO

GOAL

CONFLICT

TURN

+ / -

SCENE CARDS · 37–42

#37

☐

INT

☐

EXT

☐

DAY

☐

NIGHT

pg ____

LOCATION

WHO

GOAL

CONFLICT

TURN

+ / -

#38

☐

INT

☐

EXT

☐

DAY

☐

NIGHT

pg ____

LOCATION

WHO

GOAL

CONFLICT

TURN

+ / -

#39

☐

INT

☐

EXT

☐

DAY

☐

NIGHT

pg ____

LOCATION

WHO

GOAL

CONFLICT

TURN

+ / -

#40

☐

INT

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EXT

☐

DAY

☐

NIGHT

pg ____

LOCATION

WHO

GOAL

CONFLICT

TURN

+ / -

#41

☐

INT

☐

EXT

☐

DAY

☐

NIGHT

pg ____

LOCATION

WHO

GOAL

CONFLICT

TURN

+ / -

#42

☐

INT

☐

EXT

☐

DAY

☐

NIGHT

pg ____

LOCATION

WHO

GOAL

CONFLICT

TURN

+ / -

SCENE CARDS · 43–48

#43

☐ INT ☐ EXT ☐ DAY ☐ NIGHT

pg ____

LOCATION

WHO

GOAL

CONFLICT

TURN

+ / -

#44

☐ INT ☐ EXT ☐ DAY ☐ NIGHT

pg ____

LOCATION

WHO

GOAL

CONFLICT

TURN

+ / -

#45

☐ INT ☐ EXT ☐ DAY ☐ NIGHT

pg ____

LOCATION

WHO

GOAL

CONFLICT

TURN

+ / -

#46

☐ INT ☐ EXT ☐ DAY ☐ NIGHT

pg ____

LOCATION

WHO

GOAL

CONFLICT

TURN

+ / -

#47

☐ INT ☐ EXT ☐ DAY ☐ NIGHT

pg ____

LOCATION

WHO

GOAL

CONFLICT

TURN

+ / -

#48

☐ INT ☐ EXT ☐ DAY ☐ NIGHT

pg ____

LOCATION

WHO

GOAL

CONFLICT

TURN

+ / -

SCENE CARDS · 49–54

#49

☐ INT ☐ EXT ☐ DAY ☐ NIGHT

pg ____

LOCATION

WHO

GOAL

CONFLICT

TURN

+ / -

#50

☐ INT ☐ EXT ☐ DAY ☐ NIGHT

pg ____

LOCATION

WHO

GOAL

CONFLICT

TURN

+ / -

#51

☐ INT ☐ EXT ☐ DAY ☐ NIGHT

pg ____

LOCATION

WHO

GOAL

CONFLICT

TURN

+ / -

#52

☐ INT ☐ EXT ☐ DAY ☐ NIGHT

pg ____

LOCATION

WHO

GOAL

CONFLICT

TURN

+ / -

#53

☐ INT ☐ EXT ☐ DAY ☐ NIGHT

pg ____

LOCATION

WHO

GOAL

CONFLICT

TURN

+ / -

#54

☐ INT ☐ EXT ☐ DAY ☐ NIGHT

pg ____

LOCATION

WHO

GOAL

CONFLICT

TURN

+ / -

SCENE CARDS · 55–60

#55

☐

INT

☐

EXT

☐

DAY

☐

NIGHT

pg ____

LOCATION

WHO

GOAL

CONFLICT

TURN

+ / -

#56

☐

INT

☐

EXT

☐

DAY

☐

NIGHT

pg ____

LOCATION

WHO

GOAL

CONFLICT

TURN

+ / -

#57

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INT

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EXT

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DAY

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pg ____

LOCATION

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CONFLICT

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#58

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LOCATION

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#59

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DAY

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NIGHT

pg ____

LOCATION

WHO

GOAL

CONFLICT

TURN

+ / -

#60

☐

INT

☐

EXT

☐

DAY

☐

NIGHT

pg ____

LOCATION

WHO

GOAL

CONFLICT

TURN

+ / -

Step Outline

Scene by scene, in order. What happens, and why does the story need it?

#	SCENE HEADING	WHAT HAPPENS / PURPOSE	PG
1			
2			
3			
4			
5			
6			
7			
8			
9			
10			
11			

STEP OUTLINE (CONT.)			
#	SCENE HEADING	WHAT HAPPENS / PURPOSE	PG
12			
13			
14			
15			
16			
17			
18			
19			
20			
21			
22			
23			

STEP OUTLINE (CONT.)		WHAT HAPPENS / PURPOSE	
#	SCENE HEADING		PG
24			
25			
26			
27			
28			
29			
30			
31			
32			
33			
34			
35			

STEP OUTLINE (CONT.)			
#	SCENE HEADING	WHAT HAPPENS / PURPOSE	PG
36			
37			
38			
39			
40			
41			
42			
43			
44			
45			
46			
47			

STEP OUTLINE (CONT.)			
#	SCENE HEADING	WHAT HAPPENS / PURPOSE	PG
48			
49			
50			
51			
52			
53			
54			
55			
56			
57			
58			
59			

draft pg _____

SCRIPT · PAGE 2

draft pg _____

draft pg _____

draft pg _____

SCRIPT · PAGE 5

draft pg _____

draft pg _____

SCRIPT · PAGE 7

draft pg _____

draft pg _____

SCRIPT · PAGE 9

draft pg _____

SCRIPT · PAGE 10

draft pg _____

draft pg _____

SCRIPT · PAGE 12

draft pg _____

SCRIPT · PAGE 13

draft pg _____

SCRIPT · PAGE 14

draft pg _____

SCRIPT · PAGE 15

draft pg _____

SCRIPT · PAGE 16

draft pg _____

SCRIPT · PAGE 17

draft pg _____

SCRIPT · PAGE 18

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SCRIPT · PAGE 19

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SCRIPT · PAGE 20

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SCRIPT · PAGE 21

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SCRIPT · PAGE 22

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SCRIPT · PAGE 23

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SCRIPT · PAGE 26

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SCRIPT · PAGE 27

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SCRIPT · PAGE 28

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SCRIPT · PAGE 29

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SCRIPT · PAGE 30

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SCRIPT · PAGE 31

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SCRIPT · PAGE 34

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SCRIPT · PAGE 35

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SCRIPT · PAGE 36

draft pg _____

SCRIPT · PAGE 37

draft pg _____

SCRIPT · PAGE 38

draft pg _____

SCRIPT · PAGE 39

draft pg _____

SCRIPT · PAGE 40

draft pg _____

Rewrite Checklist

Do one pass per focus. Tick each item when the draft passes.

STRUCTURE PASS

- ☐ The inciting incident lands early enough (film: by ~p. 12).
- ☐ The hero makes an active choice to enter Act II.
- ☐ The midpoint changes the direction or stakes of the story.
- ☐ The climax is won or lost by the hero's own choice.
- ☐ Every scene earns its place. Could two be combined?

CHARACTER PASS

- ☐ Every character wants something in every scene they're in.
- ☐ The protagonist changes (or tragically refuses to).
- ☐ The antagonist is at least as capable as the hero.
- ☐ Cover the names: can you tell who is speaking?

SCENE PASS

- ☐ Each scene enters late and leaves early.
- ☐ Each scene turns: a value shifts from + to - or - to +.
- ☐ There is conflict or tension in every scene.

NOTES

Rewrite Checklist (cont.)

DIALOGUE PASS

- ☐ Subtext over on-the-nose: people rarely say what they mean.
- ☐ Greetings, small talk and filler lines are cut.
- ☐ Exposition is dramatized, not explained.

POLISH PASS

- ☐ Action paragraphs are four lines or fewer; present tense, active verbs.
- ☐ Speaking characters are in CAPS, with an age, the first time we meet them.
- ☐ Page count sits in range; spelling and formatting are clean.

NOTES

How to Use This Workbook

A path from idea to finished draft.

1**IDEA**

Nail the logline first. If you can't say it in one sentence, the story isn't clear yet.

2**STORY**

Map the structure: acts, beats and sequences (film) or bible, arc and episodes (TV).

3**CAST**

Give every major character a want, a need and a flaw that puts them in conflict.

4**SCENES**

Brainstorm scenes on cards. Each needs a goal, a conflict and a turn.

5**OUTLINE**

Put the cards in order as a step outline. Fix structure here, not in pages.

6**SCRIPT**

Draft by hand on the guided pages: dotted lines mark where action, dialogue, parentheticals and character names start. Or type in Fountain and format it with the app.

7**NOTES**

Rewrite in passes, and log feedback from readers.

TIPS FOR THE REMARKABLE

- Links work when you tap with a finger or the pen tip. Close the side toolbar for the full page.
- Use the fineliner or ballpoint at the thinnest size so handwriting fits between the lines.
- Duplicate the PDF before you start a new project, and keep this copy as a blank template.
- Rename the PDF to your script's title so it's easy to find in My Files.

Screenplay Format

The industry-standard page. Readers judge format in seconds.

Scene heading

INT. DINER - NIGHT

Action

Rain streaks the windows. MAYA (30s, tired eyes) slides into a booth across from OTIS.

Character

MAYA

Parenthetical

(quietly)

Dialogue

You said you'd come alone.

OTIS

I did. They followed me.

Transition

CUT TO:

ELEMENT	FROM LEFT	WIDTH	RULES
Scene heading	1.5"	6.0"	INT./EXT. LOCATION - DAY/NIGHT, all caps.
Action	1.5"	6.0"	Present tense; what we see and hear. ≤ 4 lines.
Character	3.7"	—	CAPS. Add (V.O.), (O.S.) or (CONT'D) as needed.
Parenthetical	3.1"	2.0"	Brief, lowercase; use sparingly.
Dialogue	2.5"	3.5"	What they say. No quotation marks.
Transition	right	—	CUT TO:, ends at 7.5". Rarely needed.

- Page: US Letter, Courier 12 pt, 1" top & bottom, 1.5" left, 1" right. Page numbers top right.
- One page ≈ one minute of screen time.
- Introduce speaking characters in CAPS with an age the first time they appear.
- Write only what the camera can see or the microphone can hear.

Typing Your Draft: Fountain

Fountain is plain text that the Script Writer app formats into a proper screenplay PDF.

SCENE HEADING **INT. DINER - NIGHT**
Starts with INT, EXT, EST or I/E, or force with .

ACTION **Maya slides into the booth.**
Any ordinary paragraph.

CHARACTER **MAYA**
A line in CAPS, then dialogue on the next line.

EXTENSION **MAYA (V.O.)**
V.O., O.S., CONT'D in parentheses.

PARENTHETICAL **(quietly)**
On its own line under the character.

DIALOGUE **You said you'd come alone.**
Lines right after the character.

TRANSITION **CUT TO:**
Caps, ending in TO:, or force with >.

CENTERED **> THE END <**
Wrap in > and <.

LYRICS **~Oh the last train north**
Start the line with ~.

EMPHASIS ***italic* **bold** _underline_**

SECTION **# ACT ONE**
Not printed; becomes a bookmark.

SYNOPSIS **= Maya finds the ticket.**
Not printed; shows in the stats report.

NOTE **[[check this later]]**
Not printed.

PAGE BREAK **===**

TITLE PAGE **Title: My Script**
Key: value lines at the top of the file.

Length & Format Reference

Typical page counts. One page ≈ one minute.

TYPE	PAGES	NOTES
Feature: comedy / horror	90–105	Shorter, faster.
Feature: drama / thriller	100–120	
Feature: epic	120–135	Harder to sell from a new writer.
Half-hour: single-camera	25–35	Film-style format.
Half-hour: multi-camera	45–55	Double-spaced dialogue; caps action.
One-hour drama	50–65	Teaser + 4–5 acts, or no act breaks for streaming.
Short film	5–15	Festivals favor under 15 minutes.

WORDS TO KNOW

Spec script	Written on your own to sell or show, not commissioned. No camera directions or scene numbers.
Shooting script	Production draft with scene numbers, revision colors and locked pages.
Slugline	Another name for the scene heading.
Beat	A single story moment, or (in dialogue) a pause: "A beat."
Button	A strong last line or image that ends a scene.
Cold open / teaser	The pre-credits scene of a TV episode that hooks the audience.
Act out	The cliffhanger at the end of a TV act, before a commercial break.
Bible	The TV document describing the series: world, characters, arcs and future seasons.